

depending on whether you're in charge of making the most of man hours or not.

So what does a company that makes free games on social networks have that values it at above \$7 billion (that's about ₹. 35,000 crore)? You, of course!

With banner ads, video ads, product placement, and the real cash cow – cash for cows! Well, not really cash for cows, but a dollar or two for virtual goods, or the ability to keep playing... Multiply that dollar or two into even a fraction of the 50 million daily players, and you get your "Aha!" moment.

We're pretty convinced Zynga employs psychiatrists as game designers. The games are designed to progress slowly, and in spurts, taking advantage of some basic human traits – addiction, impatience, obligation and individuality. So you build a farm to suit your individuality, and are obligated to help those who help you, are thus addicted to the game, and since there's no real end to it, you get impatient and are willing to pay to speed up your progress. Ingenious!

Plus, of course, Zynga has all your information to make a profile of you. Sure, it may not sell that information it has about you as an individual, but you still figure as part of a group or demographic, and that information they're free to sell.

Wisdom (and other services)

Thanks to Facebook, we know that our Digit account on Facebook is liked or added as a friend mostly by males (~90 percent), most of them between ages of 13 to 34 (91 percent), with the 18 to 24 age group being the most popular (60 percent). After India (obviously), Nepal is the country where we have the most Digit fans, followed by the US and Pakistan a distant fourth.

However, we can get more information about you, just by installing an app called Wisdom (www.wisdom.com). From there, we can get additional data – for instance, we know 81% of our followers are single, most are talking about Class 12 board exams, the most popular check-in place is Mumbai's Chhatrapati Shivaji Airport, the most female followers of Digit are from New Delhi, and yes most are single, and we can even tell who the most influential followers are...

Note: We installed the Wisdom app only recently, specifically for this article, and honestly, we couldn't care less how many girlfriends or boyfriends you have, what your age is, how you spend time on

Facebook, or for any of the data that the app gave us. However, it's our duty to let you know that such tools are available, and are being used to neatly sort and categorise you and your actions into neat little piles for later use by various companies.

The screenshots will tell you more (actual data or names are blurred to protect identities), but there are many such companies out there that mine Facebook data. It's always with permission, of course, but how many of us actually pay attention to what data apps gather about us. You want to install something, you click OK. It's that simple.

All the others

The brilliance of Facebook – for you, developers and most of all marketers – is that it takes being social to all new levels.

Imagine a world where pretty much any of your hundreds of friends knew all there was to know about you, and pretty much all of them were itching to tell absolute strangers your secrets... That shouldn't sound alarming at all, because that's exactly what Facebook is (other social networks too).

One of your friends adds a quiz app. Why? Because she (or worse, he) wants to know "Which Sex and the City Girl" she (or he!) is. Seems rather pointless, but harmless. However, the problem is that many such apps request a level of access to your friend's profile that really shouldn't be granted.

If you take your privacy seriously, have painstakingly sorted each and every friend into groups, and then spent hours setting strict security and privacy permissions for each one of those groups, and even gone to the extent of ignoring all app requests... it's all pretty useless. Rogue app developers can still get all the information they need about you, because their apps can have the same level of access to you as you've allowed the friends who have installed said apps!

This is why you'll find countless articles online that urge you to delete apps you don't



81 per cent single - come on guys!



The truth about Truths About You



CityVille wants to post to Facebook as you

use, and even some that will advise you to choose your friends on social networks as carefully as you would in real life.

Not that anyone ever will of course, because it's just too irresistible to have as many friends as you possibly can online, and of course, you'll still want to know the answer to the important questions in life... So which Sex and the City Girl are you anyway? 

OUT DAMNED APP!

Seeing which apps have access to your profile is easy. Just go to Account Settings > Apps. You will see a list of apps you have installed and more information, such as what type of data apps accessed, and when. If you want to delete an app, just click the cross mark next to it.

